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SMART PLAYLIST

Abstract

A smart playlist system is described. In one example embodiment, a collector module obtains content utilization data from a plurality of client devices associated with respective plurality of viewers. A hot list generator module generates a list of popular content items based on the obtained content utilization data. A customization module generates a customized playlist for a target viewer from the plurality of viewers, based on the list of popular content items and a profile of the target viewer. The communications module communicates the customized playlist to a client device of the target viewer.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/498,367, filed on Oct. 31, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/511,648, filed Jul. 15, 2019, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/637,561, filed on Jun. 29, 2017, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 12/877,034, filed on Sep. 7, 2010, which applications are incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] This application relates to the fields of media and entertainment and specifically to a smart playlist system.

BACKGROUND

[0003] The approaches described in this section could be pursued, but are not necessarily approaches that have been previously conceived or pursued. Therefore, unless otherwise indicated herein, the approaches described in this section are not prior art to the claims in this application and are not admitted to be prior art by inclusion in this section.

[0004] In the field of media and entertainment, there is a new generation of viewers that has a high expectation of the level of entertainment to be enjoyed from various sources of content, such as, e.g., television programming, the Internet, and locally stored content. These viewers may expect more choice, more flexibility, as well as the ability to interact and participate more with the viewable content.

[0005] On the other hand, the sheer volume of content that is available for viewing is exploding dramatically. Just the number of television channels that are now available is almost unmanageable. The amount of content that is available via free video or video on demand service is also increasing. It is now possible to view content over a wider span of time by employing time shifting technologies, such as Personal Video Recording (PVR) (sometimes referred to as DVR or Digital Video Recording). This explosion of content may be described as a paradox of choice, where the excess of choices causes a viewer's inability to choose.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0006] Embodiments are illustrated by way of example and not limitation in the figures of the accompanying drawings, in which like references indicate similar elements and in which:

[0007] FIG. 1 illustrates an environment within which an example smart playlist may be implemented, in accordance with an example embodiment;

[0008] FIG. 2 is a network diagram illustrating architecture within which a smart playlist may be utilized, in accordance with an example embodiment;

[0009] FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating a smart playlist system, in accordance with an example embodiment;

[0010] FIG. 4 is a flow chart illustrating a method for providing a smart playlist to a viewer's client device, in accordance with an example embodiment; and

[0011] FIG. 5 illustrates a diagrammatic representation of a machine in the example form of a computer system within which a set of instructions, for causing the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein, may be executed.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0012] The description that follows includes systems, methods, techniques, instruction sequences, and computing machine program products that embody illustrative embodiments of the present invention. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide an understanding of various embodiments of the inventive subject matter. It will be evident, however, to those skilled in the art that embodiments of the inventive subject matter may be practiced without these specific details. In general, well-known instruction instances, protocols, structures, and techniques have not been shown in detail.

[0013] A system is described to collect information from a great number of viewers' client devices, determine a list of popular content items based on the collected information, customize the list for a particular viewer, and send that list to the viewer's device. This approach to aiding a viewer in making choices in the universe of viewable content may be termed a smart playlist system.

Example embodiments described herein provide systems and methods to generate a smart play list.

[0014] In one embodiment, a smart playlist system obtains from viewers' client devices content-related information such as, e.g., which programs are being currently viewed, which programs are being recorded and scheduled to be recorded, which content has been rated and the associated ratings, as well as recommendations pertaining to programs, purchases of various programs, etc. For the purposes of this description the terms content, content item, show, and program will be understood to denote viewable content. Data collected indiscriminately from the entire accessible community of viewers may be accumulated in a repository termed a global bucket. Data from the global bucket may be analyzed to determine programs that appear to be most popular at the time of the analyzing, i.e., appear to be of heightened interest to viewers. A certain number of programs that have been determined as most popular are compiled into a so-called hot list. The hot list may be made available to viewer, e.g., by communicating the list to the viewers' client devices or providing an access link that can be invoked from the users' devices.

[0015] Before a hot list is provided to a viewer, it may be personalized for the viewer by determining how relevant the items in the hot list are to that particular viewer and presenting to the viewer only those programs that have been determined to be of high relevance to the viewer. The relevancy of a particular program to a particular viewer may be determined by associating each item in the hot list with a score based on the viewer's profile, on the viewer's content viewing history and patterns, as well as based on information collected from the client devices of a subset of viewers who are members of the particular viewer's social network.

[0016] In one example embodiment, in addition to determining a personalized hot list of content items, a smart playlist system may trigger recording of a certain program as soon as the program has been identified as a live program and of high relevance to the viewer. For example, a viewer may not be tuned into a channel broadcasting a particular live sports event. If the smart playlist system determined that the live sports event is of high relevance to the viewer, the smart playlist system may trigger the recording of the live broadcast of the sports event on the viewer's client device (e.g., a set top box, a desktop computer, etc.) and also alerts the user to the fact that she may be interested in the event being currently broadcast on a certain channel. The viewer may then ignore the alert. If the viewer, instead, tunes to the suggested channel the viewer would not have missed the beginning of the broadcast because the recording of the program has been automatically triggered by an instruction provided to the viewer's client device from the smart playlist system. In one example, the high relevancy of the live broadcast may have been determined based on the fact that all of the viewer's social network contacts have either tuned into the associated channel or have

scheduled the recording of the broadcast. In another example, the high relevancy of the live broadcast may have been determined based on the viewer's profile or on the viewer's viewing history. An example smart playlist system may be implemented within architecture illustrated in FIG. 1.

[0017] FIG. 1 illustrates network architecture of an example interactive media environment **100** wherein some embodiments of the present invention may be deployed. The interactive media environment **100** includes a source system **102** that communicates data (e.g., media content data and interactive application data) via a distribution network or system **104** (e.g., the Internet, a mobile communication network, or any other network capable of communicating digital data) and a modulator box **106** to a receiver system **108**. In one example embodiment, the interactive media environment **100** optionally includes a storage unit **110** (e.g., personal computer) that communicates stored data via a network **112** to the modulator box **106** which, in turn, communicates the stored data, media content data, and interactive application data to the receiver system **108**. The modulator box **106**, storage unit **110**, and the receiver system **108** may be co-located in a user's home. Thus, in one embodiment, the modulator box **106** may combine media content data and interactive application data received from the remote source system **102** with a local stored data provided by the storage unit **110** provided at the user's home.

[0018] Turning first to the source system **102**, an example headend system **114** operates to communicate the data as a broadcast transmission. To this end, the headend system **114** is shown to include one or more broadcast servers **116** and, optionally, one or more application servers **118**. Each of the broadcast servers **116** may operate to receive, encode, packetize, multiplex, modulate, and broadcast data from various sources and of various types. While the example embodiment is described herein as transmitting data from the headend system **114** as a broadcast, it will be appreciated that the relevant data could also be unicast or multicast from the source system **102** via the distribution system **104** and modulator box **106** to the receiver system **108**. In various embodiments, data could also be transmitted from the source system **102** via a network connection to the receiver system **108**. Further, in other example embodiments the source system **102** may be modified to facilitate communications via the Internet, a mobile phone network, or any other network capable of communicating digital data.

[0019] Each application server **118**, in one example embodiment, compiles and provides interactive data modules to the broadcast server **116**. The interactive data modules may also include data that is utilized by an interactive television application. The application server **118** may also include multiplexing functionality to enable multiplexing of, for example, interactive television applications and associated data with audio and video signals received from various sources. The application server **118** may also have the capability to feed (e.g., stream) multiple interactive television applications to one or more broadcast servers **116** for distribution to the receiver system **108**. To this end, each application server **118** may implement a so-called "carousel," whereby code and data modules are provided to a broadcast server **116** in a cyclic, repetitive manner for inclusion within a transmission from the headend system **114**. In other embodiments, code may reside permanently in a set-top box (STB) **120** (e.g., the code may be stored in non-volatile memory of the STB **120**), may be pushed or downloaded to the STB **120**, or be provided to the STB **120** in any other manner. In one embodiment, the application server **118** provides a smart playlist mechanism to collect information from viewers, determine a list of popular content items, customizing the list for a particular user and sending that list to the user's device. The smart playlist mechanism will be discussed by way of example in more detail in connection with FIGS. 2-4.

[0020] The headend system **114** is also shown, by way of example, to include one or more backend servers **122**, which are coupled to the application servers **118** and to an input/output device **124** (e.g., a modem pool). Specifically, the I/O device **124** is coupled to receive data from the receiver system **108** via a network **126** (e.g., the Internet) and to provide this data to backend servers **122**. The backend servers **122** may then provide the data, received from the receiver system **108**, to the

application servers **118** and the broadcast servers **116**. Alternatively, data received from the receiver system **108** may be directly provided to the application servers **118**.

[0021] Accordingly, the network **126** and the I/O device **126** may operate as a return channel whereby the receiver system **108** is provided with interactivity with the source system **102**. Data provided to the headend system **114** via the return channel may include, merely for example, user input to an interactive media application executed at the receiver system **108** or data that is generated by the receiver system **108** and communicated to the source system **102**. The return channel may also provide a channel whereby programs, targeted advertisements/commercials, and applications from the source system **102** are provided to the receiver system **108**.

[0022] Within the source system **102**, the headend system **114** is also shown optionally to receive data (e.g., content, code, and application data) from external sources. For example, the headend system **114** may be coupled to one or more content sources **128** and one or more application sources **130** via a network **132** (e.g., the Internet). For example, a content source **128** may be a provider of entertainment content (e.g., movie), a provider of real-time dynamic data (e.g., weather information), and the like. The application source **130** may be a provider of any interactive media application. For example, one or more application sources **130** may provide a TV media player application, electronic program guide and navigation applications, messaging and communication applications, information applications, and so forth. The application sources **130** may be configured to execute on different client devices (e.g., mobile phones, personal computer, STBs, or the like).

[0023] Turning now to the example distribution system **104**, the distribution system **104** may, in one embodiment, support the broadcast distribution of data from the source system **102** to the receiver system **108**. As shown, the distribution network or system **104** may comprise a satellite, cable, terrestrial or Digital Subscribers Line (DSL) network, or any other data communication network or combination of such networks.

[0024] The receiver system **108** is shown, in one example embodiment, to include the set-top box (STB) **120** that receives data (e.g., primary and secondary content streams) via the distribution system **104** and modulator box **106** and an input/output device **132** (e.g., modem) for return channel communications with the headend system **114**. The receiver system **108** is also shown to include other optional external systems such as a user input device **134** (e.g., a keyboard, remote control, mouse etc.) and a display device **136**, coupled to the set-top box **120**, for the display of content received at the set-top box **120**. In one example embodiment, the display device **136** may be a television set.

[0025] The modulator box **106**, in one example embodiment, receives stored data from the storage unit **110** and a broadcast transmission from the source system **102**. The modulator box **106** multiplexes the stored data into the broadcast transmission thereby generating a second transmission that is communicated to the receiving system **108**. It will, however, be appreciated that storage unit functionality is optional. The storage unit **110** may store data and, upon request, communicate the stored data to the modulator box **106** over the network **112** (e.g., Ethernet). The storage unit **110** may communicate the stored data in response to commands that are entered by a user from the set-top box **120** and communicated to the storage unit **110** over a link **138**.

[0026] It will be appreciated to one skilled in the art that one or more of the modules, applications, or the like of the modulator box **106**, the set-top box **120**, and the storage unit **110** may be combined or integrated. In general, components, protocols, structures, and techniques not directly related to functions of example embodiments have not been shown or discussed in detail. The description given herein simply provides a variety of example embodiments to aid the reader in an understanding of the systems and methods used herein. While the interactive media environment **100** is illustrated having a receiving system **108** including a set-top box **120**, it is noted that the receiving system **108** may comprise a mobile device or a personal computer coupled to a network for receiving media.

[0027] Smart playlist may be utilized beneficially in the context of a network environment. FIG. 1

illustrates an environment **100** within which an example smart playlist may be implemented. The environment **100** includes a set top box **110** in communication with an entertainment display device **120** and a control device **130**. The set-top box (STB) **110** may be a device that connects to a television and an external source of signal, turning the signal into content which can then be displayed on the television screen. In one example embodiment, the entertainment display device **120** is a television set, and the control device **130** is a remote control device that may be used for switching between television channels, for example. The set-top box **110** may be configured to include a system **112** to provide a smart playlist that may include features outlined above. The set-top box **110** may be configured to receive content from sources such as, e.g., an Ethernet cable, a satellite dish, a coaxial cable, a telephone line (including digital subscriber line (DSL) connections), Broadband over Power Line, as well as very high frequency (VHF) or ultra high frequency (UHF) antenna. Content, in this context, could mean any or all of video, audio, Internet web pages, interactive games, or other possibilities. As shown in FIG. 1, the set-top box **110** is shown as having access to signal sources **140**, including broadcast programming **142**, video on demand programs **144**, as well as to local content **146** and Internet content **148**.

[0028] FIG. 2 is a network diagram illustrating architecture **200** within which a smart playlist may be utilized, in accordance with an example embodiment. The architecture **100** includes a client device **210** and a client device **220**, each configured to receive content from content sources **250** and to be in communication with a server system **240** via a communications network **230**. The client devices **210** and **220** may be set top boxes, desktop computers, mobile devices, etc. The communications network **230** may be a public network (e.g., the Internet, a wireless network, etc.) or a private network (e.g., a local area network (LAN), a wide area network (WAN), Intranet, etc.). The server **240** may include a smart playlist system **242** configured to collect information related to utilization of viewable content from viewers' client devices, to aggregate and customize the collected information, and to provide the resulting hot list to viewers personalized for each particular user, as was described above.

[0029] The client device **210** may be configured to include a smart playlist agent **212** that may be configured to cooperate with the smart playlist system **242** with respect to collecting information regarding viewable content accessed or referenced on the client device **210**. In some embodiments, the smart playlist system **242** may be configured to obtain information regarding viewable content accessed or referenced on a client device without the use of a smart playlist agent. As shown in FIG. 2, the client devices **210** and **220** have access to signal sources **250**. The signal sources **250** include broadcast programming **252**, video on demand programs **254**, as well as to local content **256** and Internet content **258**. An example system to generate a smart playlist may be described with reference to FIG. 2.

[0030] FIG. 3 illustrates an example system **300** to generate a smart playlist based on content utilization information collected from client devices of the entire community of users that can be accessed by the smart playlist system. The system **300** includes a collector module **310**, a hot list generator **320**, a customization module **340**, and a communications module **350**. The collector module **310** may be configured to obtain content utilization data from a plurality of client devices (e.g., the client devices **210** and **220** of FIG. 2. The content utilization data for a viewer from the plurality of viewers may be indicative of the viewer's interest in respective content items. In one embodiment, the collector module **310** obtains content utilization data from a real time listener provided at a client device, e.g., the smart playlist agent **212** of FIG. 2. The hot list generator **320** may be configured to generate a list of popular content items based on the obtained content utilization data.

[0031] The collector module **310** obtains content utilization information from all client devices accessible to the smart playlist system **300**. This information, collected from the entire universe of viewers that have diverse tastes, viewing habits, and content source preferences and that reflects content utilization of the entire viewing community, is stored, by a storing module **340**, in a

repository termed a global bucket. The data from the global bucket is analyzed by the hot list generator **320** to determine those content items that are of most interest to the global community of viewers and assemble those content items into a list of popular items, a so-called hot list. In one embodiment, the hot list generator **320** may generate a hot list based on how many viewers are watching or recording a show, the duration of the watching, ratings and recommendations associated with the program, and so on. As the collector module **310** continuously obtains content utilization data from client devices, the hot list generator **320** may be configured to continuously update the hot list, e.g., once a day or based on any predetermined time period.

[0032] The customization module **330** may be configured to customize the hot list that is generated based on the information from the global bucket that reflect preferences of the entire community of viewers to target more closely the actual and projected preferences of a particular viewer (a target viewer) and generate a so-called customized playlist. The customizing may be based on the viewer's profile that may be stored at the application server **240** of FIG. 2, as well as on the viewing history of the viewer and the viewing history of members of the viewer's social network. In one embodiment, the storing module **340** stores content utilization data for individual viewers in respective repositories termed personal buckets. A viewer's profile stored at the application server **240** may indicate that one or more other viewers are associated with the viewers as "friends" in terms of social networking. The storing module **340** stores content utilization data collected from client devices of the viewer's "friends" or social connections in a repository termed a social bucket. The customization module **330** may utilize data from the viewer's personal bucket and the viewer's social bucket to generate the customized playlist. The customization module **330** may be configured to periodically update the customized playlist, e.g., based on the changes in the hot list, based on the changes in the data stored in the personal bucket and the social bucket, as well as based on the changes in the viewer's profile.

[0033] In one embodiment, a customized playlist is generated by generating a score for each item from the list of popular content items and including items into in the customized playlist based on respective scores of the items from the list of popular content items. The scoring may be based on the viewer's preferences identified in the viewer's profile, based on data from the viewer's personal bucket and the viewer's social bucket. A content item from a category that is not indicated in the viewer's profile as being of interest to the viewer and that is not considered as being of interest to the viewer based on the viewing history of the viewer may still be assigned a high score by the customization module **330** based on the information from the viewers social bucket. For example, the customization module **330** may be configured to weigh heavily an indication that a certain content item is of high interest to a great number of the viewer's social contacts.

[0034] The communications module **350** may be configured to communicate the customized playlist to a client device of the target viewer. The communications module **350** may be configured to communicate to the client device an instruction to start recording of a live program identified in the customized playlist. The communications module **350** may also be configured to communicate to the client device an instruction to display an alert message regarding of a live program identified in the customized playlist. As mentioned above, a client device may be a set top box, a desktop computer, or a mobile device. Content items referenced in the hot list or in the customized playlist may be associated with a variety of content sources, such as, e.g., the Internet, video on demand, and live broadcast. Example operations performed by the system **400** may be described with reference to FIG. 4.

[0035] FIG. 4 illustrates an example method **400** of providing a smart playlist. The method **400** may be performed in the context of media and entertainment, e.g., in the context of television entertainment. The method **400** may be performed by processing logic that may comprise hardware (e.g., dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (such as run on a general purpose computer system or a dedicated machine), or a combination of both. It will be noted, that, in an example embodiment, the processing logic may reside in any of the modules shown in FIG. 3.

[0036] As shown in FIG. 4, the method **400** commences with operation **410**, where the collector module **310** of FIG. 3 obtains content utilization data from a plurality of client devices associated with respective plurality of viewers. At operation **420**, the hot list generator **320** of FIG. 3 generates a list of popular content items based on the obtained content utilization data. At operation **430**, the customization module **330** of FIG. 3 generates a customized playlist for a target viewer from the plurality of viewers, based on the list of popular content items and a profile of the target viewer. At operation **440**, the communications module **340** of FIG. 3 communicates the customized playlist to a client device of the target viewer.

[0037] FIG. 5 shows a diagrammatic representation of machine in the example form of a computer system within which a set of instructions, for causing the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein, may be executed. In alternative embodiments, the machine operates as a standalone device or may be connected (e.g., networked) to other machines. In a networked deployment, the machine may operate in the capacity of a server or a client machine in server-client network environment, or as a peer machine in a peer-to-peer (or distributed) network environment. The machine may be a personal computer (PC), a tablet PC, a set-top box (STB), a Personal Digital Assistant (PDA), a cellular telephone, a web appliance, a network router, switch or bridge, or any machine capable of executing a set of instructions (sequential or otherwise) that specify actions to be taken by that machine. Further, while only a single machine is illustrated, the term “machine” shall also be taken to include any collection of machines that individually or jointly execute a set (or multiple sets) of instructions to perform any one or more of the methodologies discussed herein.

[0038] The example computer system **500** includes a processor **502** (e.g., a central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU) or both), a main memory **504** and a static memory **506**, which communicate with each other via a bus **508**. The computer system **500** may further include a video display unit **510** (e.g., a liquid crystal display (LCD) or a cathode ray tube (CRT)). The computer system **500** also includes an alphanumeric input device **512** (e.g., a real or virtual keyboard), a viewer interface (UI) navigation device **514** (e.g., a remote control or a mouse), a disk drive unit **516**, a signal generation device **518** (e.g., a speaker) and a network interface device **520**.

[0039] The disk drive unit **516** includes a machine-readable medium **522** on which is stored one or more sets of instructions and data structures (e.g., software **524**) embodying or utilized by any one or more of the methodologies or functions described herein. The software **524** may also reside, completely or at least partially, within the main memory **504**, within the processor **502** during execution thereof by the computer system **500**, the main memory **504** and the processor **502** also constituting machine-readable media. The main memory **504** comprises storage locations that are addressable by the processor **502** for storing software program code. The memory may comprise a form of random access memory (RAM). Those skilled in the art will appreciate that other memory means, such as FLASH memory media, may also be used for storing the program instructions and data structures shown in the main memory **504**.

[0040] The software **524** may further be transmitted or received over a network **526** via the network interface device **520** utilizing any one of a number of well-known transfer protocols (e.g., HTTP).

[0041] While the machine-readable medium **522** is shown in an example embodiment to be a single medium, the term “machine-readable medium” may be taken to include a single medium or multiple media (e.g., a centralized or distributed database, and/or associated caches and servers) that store the one or more sets of instructions. The term “machine-readable medium” shall also be taken to include any medium (e.g., FLASH memory media) that is capable of storing, encoding or carrying a set of instructions for execution by the machine and that cause the machine to perform any one or more of the methodologies of the present invention, or that is capable of storing, encoding or carrying data structures utilized by or associated with such a set of instructions. The term “machine-readable medium” shall accordingly be taken to include, but not be limited to, solid-

state memories, optical and magnetic media.

[0042] The embodiments described herein may be implemented in an operating environment comprising software installed on a computer, in hardware, or in a combination of software and hardware.

[0043] Thus, method and system to generate and update a smart playlist have been described. In the description above, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details have been set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of one example embodiment. It will be evident, however, to one skilled in the art that the present invention may be practiced without these specific details. It is to be noted that the delivery mechanism for the content for viewing may be via a satellite, cable, terrestrial broadcast, Internet, local storage, a local network, mobile telephony, or any other content distribution network. Accordingly, the viewing device need not be a television set but may be any display unit of any device (including portable devices). It will be noted that any references to television content will be understood to include any content available for viewing on an entertainment display device, such as a television screen. Such content may include television programming, as well as locally stored content, such as stored video files or digital images, as well as content accessible via the Internet. It will be noted that the term viewer may be understood broadly as any viewer of the system to navigate television content.

Claims

1. A computer-implemented method of providing one or more content recommendations, the method comprising: collecting, via one or more servers in communication with a plurality of client devices (220), content utilization data indicative of a history and patterns with a plurality of content items by one or more viewers; analyzing, by at least one application server, the content utilization data to identify a set of popular content items among the plurality of content items, the identification being based at least in part on utilization information associated with each of the plurality of content items; obtaining a profile data associated with a viewer, wherein the profile data comprises a content viewing history of the viewer; generating, by at least one application server from the set of popular content items, a list of recommended content items for the viewer derived from at least the content viewing history of the viewer; and transmitting, over a communications network, the list of recommended content items to a client device of the viewer for display on a user interface.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the collecting step is performed by a collector module collecting content utilization of an entire viewing community.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the list of recommended content items comprises categories of interest to the viewer.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein a recommended content item of the list is posted on a social networking application.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein the viewer's viewing history is determined by a social network of the viewer.
6. The method of claim 1, wherein the generating step comprises generating the list of recommended content items for the viewer further from stored data, media content data, and interactive applications.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the generating step comprises generating the list of recommended content items for the viewer further from data provided by an application source.
8. The method of claim 7, wherein the application source is an interactive media application.
9. The method of claim 7, wherein the application source is a communication application.
10. The method of claim 7, wherein the application source is configured to execute on a mobile phone.
11. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items of the list of recommended

content items is selected from the group consisting of: video, audio, Internet web pages, interactive games, broadcast programming, video on demand programs, local content, and targeted advertisements.

12. The method of claim 1, wherein the content utilization data is collected from real time listeners provided at the plurality of client devices.

13. The method of claim 12, wherein the content utilization data is collected from all the client devices.

14. The method of claim 1 further comprising continuously updating the content utilization data.

15. The method of claim 1 wherein the profile data of the viewer contains information collected from social connections of the viewer.

16. The method of claim 1 wherein the content utilization data is collected from a viewing history of one or more social connections of the user.

17. The method of claim 1 wherein assigning the score comprises assigning a higher score for live content than other content.

18. The method of claim 1 wherein the list of recommended content is based on viewing habits of social connections of the viewer.

19. The method of claim 1 wherein the list of recommended content is based on the profile data of the viewer.

20. The method of claim 1, wherein the locally stored data comprises the viewer viewing history, purchases, recording of content, and Internet content.

21. The method of claim 1, wherein the one or more viewers includes the viewer.

22. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise video.

23. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise audio.

24. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise Internet web pages.

25. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise interactive games.

26. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise broadcast programming.

27. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise video on demand programs.

28. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise local content.

29. The method of claim 1, wherein the recommended content items comprise targeted advertisements.
